commencement of its operations about a decade ago, DTZ-OZGEO has been panning for gold on the banks. For a stretch of over three kilometres, the Mutare River has been reduced to a canal while vegetation on either side of the river has disappeared. Water in the river has become perennially muddy due to panning. Yet the Mutare River is a major source of drinking water for humans, livestock and wild animals further downstream.

In August 2013 the company was temporarily stopped from its environmentally unfriendly mining activities but later resumed operations, doing exactly the same things they had been fined for. DTZ-OZGEO co-director, Ismail Shillaev, speaking during a media tour for journalists from Mutare on 24 June 2011, could not convincingly explain their operations, insisting that they sell their gold to Fidelity Printers. When asked to explain the actual quantities they were getting on a daily basis, he remained silent. Shillaev said they were involved in community development work when approached by local authorities like the Mutasa Rural District Council. He said they had rehabilitated some of the roads in the district, but most roads remain impassable.

A 2013 visit to Tsvingwe Primary School exposed a distinct lack of corporate social responsibility: children were learning in the open even during the dead of winter due to a shortage of classroom blocks. Tsvingwe Primary School is situated about a kilometre from the DTZ operations. Authorities at the school also expressed their disappointment with DTZ-OZGEO, adding that most of their pupils' parents worked for the company. The pupils are also exposed to new environmental hazards such as the increasing occurrence of dust in the air, the disappearance of vegetation and impassable roads due to DTZ-OZGEO's operations. The smash and grab operations of DTZ-OZGEO, coupled with the failure by the company even to construct houses for its employees, reveal a company that has no long-term plans for the community.

South Africa

Due to its proximity to Zimbabwe and close political relations over the past century, many South African companies have invested in Zimbabwe's mining sector. The major players have been De Beers, Gold Fields, Implats, Aquarius Platinum and Anglo American plc. Anglo American and its subsidiary companies have invested in Zimbabwe for 60 years.

While De Beers was fingered in murky underhand dealings in Marange from 1965 to 2006, most South African investors have performed more reasonably in terms of safety, health and environment and literacy levels of employees. Indeed, many researchers remark that South African companies in the platinum sector